

Jan 13, 2026

During class, Carl Cox briefly talked about his winter break. He didn't leave Georgia this time, although he usually would travel up north where his family resides.

While this was a small personal update, it helped set a relaxed and conversational tone for the rest of the class.

We are going to continue with our CareerCorps app. On the whiteboard, we brainstormed about what the app itself contains/would contain. Everyone in class wrote down some points about how the features their group developed last semester could contribute to a feature listed on the whiteboard.

Target user: military spouse that is looking for:

- Job, general career advice, support during relocation

Possible app features discussed:

- Create profile, upload resumes, AI recommendations based on resume, support groups/peer connections, mentor matching (already included in previous semester)
- Page dedicated to learning more about careerCorps
- See nearby jobs

It was mostly brainstorming as we decide the next direction that we are heading towards.

Homework:

- Last semester, we built an initial set of tools for "Career Corp".
- What is the goal of "Career Corp" from your point of view?
- What are the purposes and goals?
- What would you add to Career Corp to further those goals that haven't already been created?

From my point of view, the purpose of CareerCorp is to help military spouses find careers despite setbacks like frequent relocation, unpredictable schedule, and lack of support in general. CareerCorp serves as a tool for military spouses to make progress towards their career by providing guidance towards the job searching process. CareerCorp can help military spouses recognize their strength and skills so they can find the appropriate jobs. It also helps connect military spouses to support groups, whether that be AI, a group of people with similar background, or a support specialist. The end goal for CareerCorp is so that military spouses could find a stable career that aligns with their interest. I would like to expand CareerCorp to support more locations because military spouses often relocate, so having just a single location would not be optimal. I would also add a resume and cover letter builder feature so that military spouses have an easier time with the job application process.

"Bob"

Military Spouse

- * Looking For Job
- * Help/General Career Advice

Create profile

- Learn About Career Corps
 - Success Stories
 - Resources
 - About "Career Co"
- See jobs near you
- Expand/understand more about peer users
 - support group

Provide

- Update Resume
- Provide Preferences for:
 - Job
 - Support Group/Peers

Receive job suggestions/decisions based on specific theme

Learn

- Monitor/learn new activities, expand on career path
- Monitor/learn new activities, expand on career path

Participate in Peer-Matching

- select from suggested group
- 1-speed date

Monitor

- monitor chosen monitor
- monitor chosen monitor

Ask if Challenging personal questions

- accept our position
- related resources

goes into about

Jan 20, 2026

Group discussion centered around the idea of implementing an in-person support group for military spouses.

Why would people come to the website?

- Looking for jobs near military bases
- Translating prior experience into civilian roles
- Resume building and improvement
- Personalized job matching
- Mentorship and guidance

How would our tool help with larger goals?

- LLM-powered resume building for a stronger job application
- AI homework hints for skill building
- Mentor matching algorithm for mentorship
- Crowd sourced success stories for inspirations and real examples

What would the user get out of it?

- Meeting new people
- Building a sense of community
- Emotional and professional support
- Third place outside of homework

Structure and standards?

- Establish a clear code of conducts
- Setting expectations for respectful and professional interaction

Idea to Recruit currently employed military spouses:

- Provide Testimonial
- Share successful stories

What are the incentives for these people to join us?

- For Companies: wider hiring pool of qualified candidates
- participants: networking, referrals, encouragement

Major identified challenge:

- How to actually provide and sustain in person support
- Logistic
- Ensure consistent participation

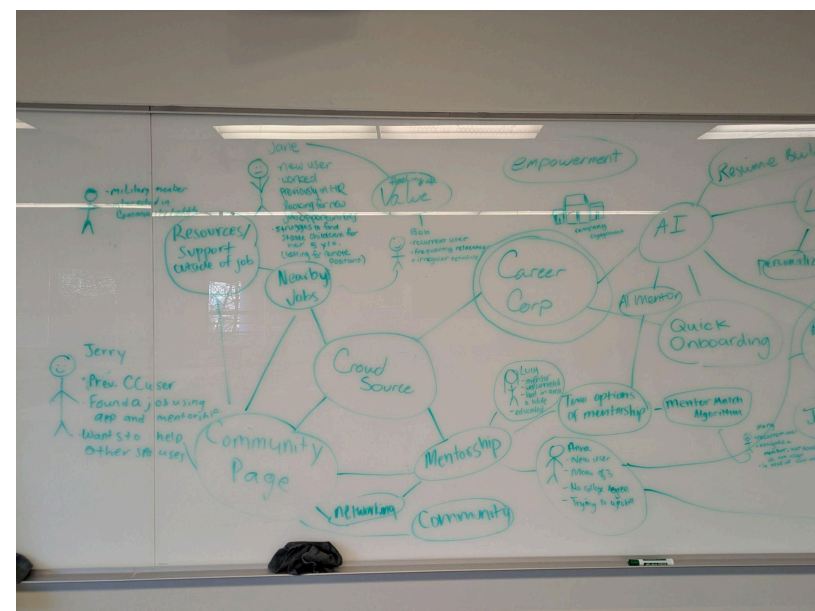
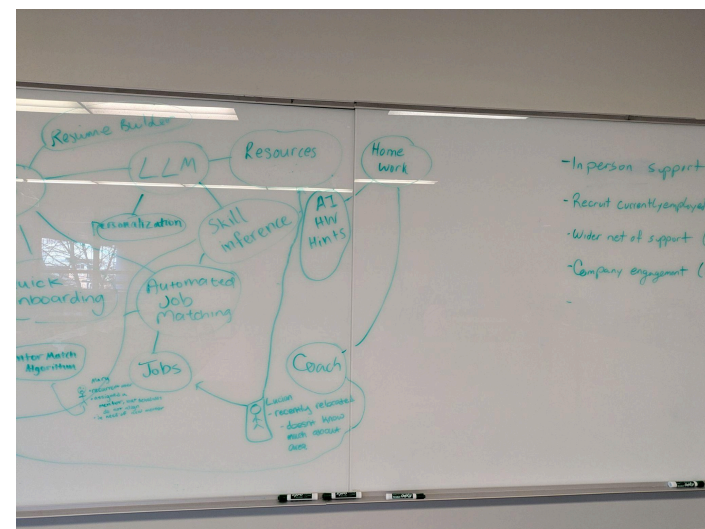
Overall, today was a lot of exploration brainstorming and focused on long term sustainability of the community component of CareerCorps.

Homework: Continue to brainstorm

- Why would people come to the website?
- How would our tools help with larger goals?
- New things to implement: Broad and big

The class's board:

- In person support group
- Recruit currently employed military spouses
- Wider net of support (childcare, local services)
- Company engagement (Career fairs, best practices)
-



January 27, 2026

Five ideas the class inputted:

- interviews with spouses
- Events + stronger community integration
- Gamify user interaction
- Career confidence builder
- Highlighting Successful stories

My contribution to the topic discussion: Successful stories from past users:

- Users who have previously used the platform can go back to it and contribute to the platform by sharing how they were able to utilize our platform to get a career.
- They could also recruit current users into their current company or represent their company at a career fair.

Moon's input:

- job finding can be isolating,
- career coaches can help reduce that isolation
- Inspired by a podcast episode about job searching

Class Debate: Should we focus our platform toward community or personal empowerment?

- If we focus on community: if people don't want to participate in the app, then it isn't going to work.
- Reference toward a previous project (a platform looking for study groups within GaTech).

Carl Cox's suggestion: Instead of splitting into teams, we should work on one ambitious idea.

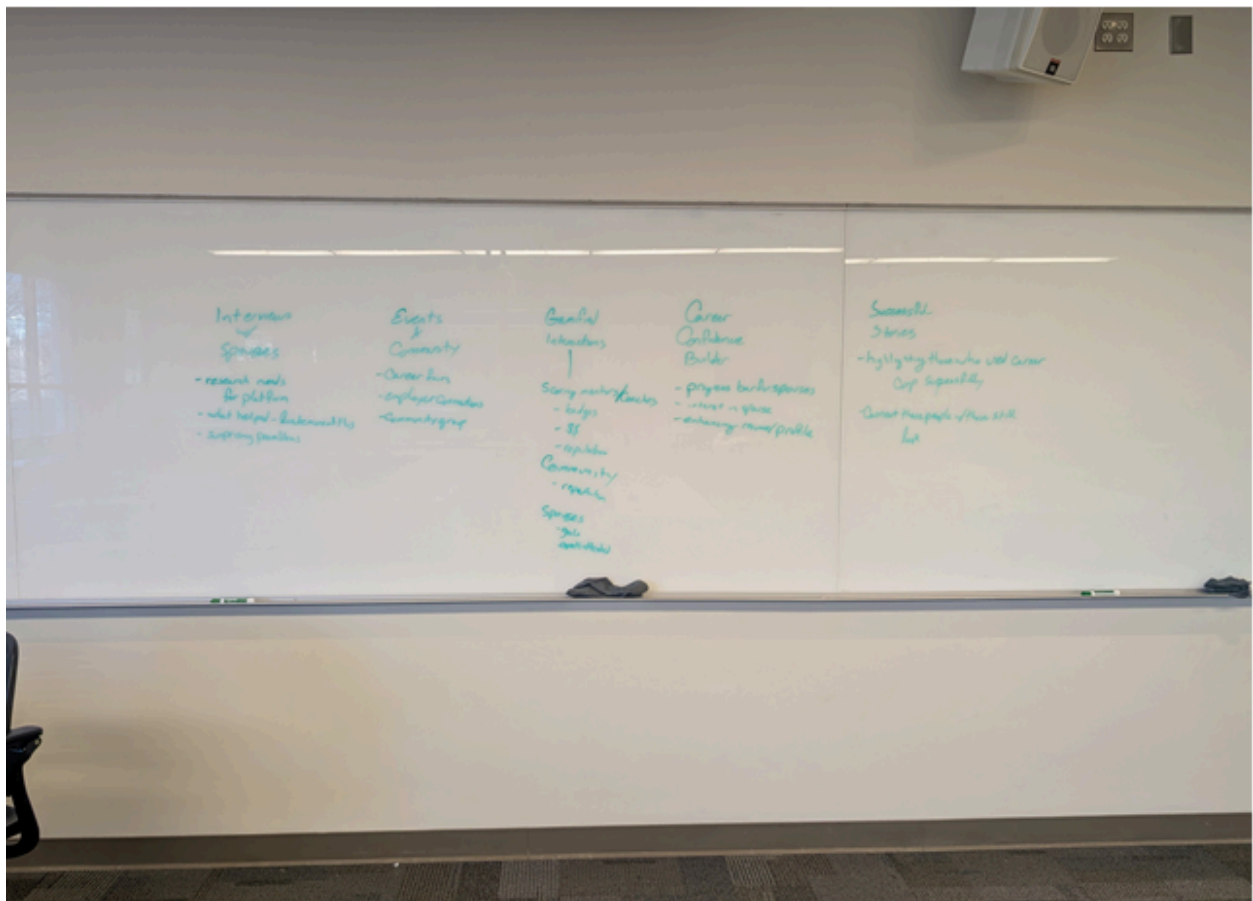
Homework:

- Think of an idea and pitch (2-5 min) your idea.
- Two approaches:
 - expand on last semester's idea
 - explore a brand new idea

Last class, we talked about whether we should focus on community or personal empowerment. I think we should focus on personal empowerment, helping users as individuals, rather than building a community for multiple users. There are many existing platforms that provide community and connections for military spouses, like reddit or other social media. I believe having a platform that focuses on self improvement would be more valuable. Specifically, I want our platform to be able to effectively take information about the users and provide customized recommendations and advice for the users. There are two features I want to explore: the first feature is a resume building that helps users build and improve their resumes. The second feature provides resources to support military spouses on other shortcomings that may be

preventing them from finding a career. For example, this feature can help military spouses look for means of transportation if transportation is something that prevents military spouses from finding a career. We should incorporate AI as a means to communicate with the users and build responses based on users input. I believe focusing on personal growth is more effective overall because the platform could still serve its purpose even if there aren't many active users, so we can still help that small number of users. Whereas a community requires a minimum number of users that are actively contributing to it to the community to be used effectively.

In class board:



February 3, 2026

Plan for this class:

- each student pitches their idea,
- then the rest of the class summarize that idea in a few words to write on the white board
- Goal: identify patterns and overlapping themes

Idea 1:

- Building a cohesive app with all the implementations of last semesters

Idea 2:

- One stop application to build career readiness.
- Have two focuses: helper using and building a community.

Idea 3:

- unify 3 groups, focus on users' flow:
 - how spouses would look at the vs how mentors work.
- Test how much engagement the app would have.

Idea 4:

- focus on testing because we made a lot of assumptions

Idea 5:

- 30 day plan with tasks for users to do with previous users providing their story.

We decided on Idea 5: personalized plan for goals

Question to ask:

- What would the personalized plan look like?
- Think of some ways we can do to implement this idea
- How can what we did before fit it with this plan

Homework:

I think this semester, we should work on a personalized action plan, powered by AI. From the very start, the user would fill out an onboarding form that provides some information about themselves. Based on the user's input, the system would generate a detailed, step-by-step plan that is personalized to the user's goal. In order for the plan to be as specific to the user as possible, the system would collect:

- Career goals (which industry? Long term or short term)
- Education level (certification?)
- Military spouse specific constraint (frequent relocation)
- Current blockers (resume gaps, lack of experience)

Essentially, it is a very clear step by step roadmap which tasks/checklists that users can do. For example, week 1 could be focused on updating resumes, week 2 is to apply to at least 5 jobs, week 3 is to get a certification. The checklist would be adaptive, tracking which task the user skipped or completed in order to generate appropriate new tasks. For example, upon completing a task, we could generate new steps to take, but if the user skips a task, the system

could suggest an alternative task. This would make the platform more interactive and alive that is not static.

Additionally, there would be a minor “community” feature where users can comment on existing tasks so that future users can see. This could let other users know more about the task from another user’s standpoint. The system could also learn from the user’s comment.

This idea would be a completely different direction than the one we took last semester. We could still incorporate some previously used material, like the AI chatbot as the personalized action plan would also be powered by AI. It still fits into CareerCorp with the goal to help military spouses find careers, but focusing more on personal empowerment rather than community .

February 10, 2026

We discussed two possible approaches for organizing team progress moving forward:

- Approach 1: student as scrum master
 - Team meet outside of class to coordinate progress
 - More ownership and leadership from students
 - Allows class time focus on development instead of logistics
 - Requires strong communication and commitment outside class
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- Approach 2: instructors as scrum master
 - Use class time for planning, updates, and alignment
 - Less responsibility on students
 - Reduce flexibility
 - More structured and guidance

Discussed project planning (february), development (march), demo (april), retro (post demo reflection)

Assigned focused areas:

- AI goal setter
- gap analysis,
- mentoring/client workflow

Scrum reminder:

- Everyone must have something to work on this week.
- NExt week: 15 min scrum review
- Each person will share what they worked on
- What they accomplished
- Next start

The class's board:

